

The Clamp

The clamps on the Tech-Com SSD-644K and SSD-642K are not suited for LCD panels, but work well with laptops. The other webcams that have a clamp for attaching to a LCD panel adopt almost the same mechanism.

The Desktop-only webcams—the Tech-Com SSD-640K and SSD-641-MP, and the Logitech QuickCam Go, don't have the clamp required to support them on laptops and LCDs. However, the stable base of the QuickCam Go means it won't topple easily.

Image Capture Resolution

Software interpolation allows captured images to be scaled to higher resolutions, and is found on many webcams. This allows them to take higher-resolution still images compared to the maximum video resolution supported, a useful feature if you want to set the image as the Desktop background or print high-resolution images.

Aesthetics And Build Quality

The Tech-Com SSD-644K with eight LEDs surrounding the lens looks attractive, but the use

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Tech-Com SSD-644K

Fragile yet firing performance

of cheap plastic means the lifespan will be short. The Tech-Com SSD-642K is shaped like a foot (!), with four LEDs on its "fingers," and the snapshot button on its "toe."

The ball-shaped, pretty, white QuickCam Go boasts of rugged build quality with a flexible rubber base. Both the Zebronic products—the 480 WC and 280 WC—have average build quality.

Accessories

The QuickCam Go is installation-friendly with its long 180-cm USB cord, as well as good software with detailed documentation. In addition to this, the Vista support in the Logitech drivers in this price bracket is a welcome feature. The Tech-Com SSD-640K bundles Ulead software.

Performance

In Daylight

Webcams work best in good lighting conditions, as you know. However, the performance of the Tech-Com SSD-640K and 641-MP was just passable. Colour reproduction was not a problem for most of the contenders, but sharpness was. Still images captured by the Logitech QuickCam Go and the Tech-Com SSD-644K and SSD-645K were better in terms of sharpness.

In Fluorescent Light

Under fluorescent lighting conditions, colour tones reproduced are greatly affected by the auto exposure / white balance controls of the webcam. The SSD-644K excelled in our colour reproduction test, and close behind were the SSD-645K and the Intex IT 305 WC. The SSD-644K had a fine balance between brightness and contrast.

Night Vision

The Tech-com SSD-644K was the best performer in dark lighting conditions; most of the others failed to generate viewable images. The Zebronic 280 WC, too, performed notably well.

